

Pascal Gets Off The Ground

Development on Pascal was started by Niklaus Wirth, who wanted to create a language to teach programming concepts to students. Based on another computer language, ALGOL, which was also developed by Wirth, Pascal incorporated features of other languages of the time, like COBOL and FORTRAN. The development was completed in 1970. The advantages of the language ensured that it was accepted in non-academic circles as well.

1969

UNIX, And The First Dialup Service

April: UNIX

Bell Laboratories, originally a part of the team tasked with creating the Multics time-sharing system, a project funded by ARPA, did not agree with the emphasis on multi-user capabilities, so it began working on its own operating system. Programmers Kenneth Thompson and Dennis Ritchie developed the UNIX operating system as a consequence. UNIX, which laid emphasis on single-user features, was deliberately named so in contrast to Multics to emphasize this aspect. Nevertheless, UNIX did sport many of the timesharing and file management features offered by Multics.

May: And Then Came AMD

Jerry Sanders the Director of Marketing at Fairchild Semiconductor started a company along with seven other Fairchild employees. The company was Advanced Micro Devices. AMD would pose the strongest challenge to Intel in the micro-processor market.

October: The Beginnings Of The IC

Busicom, an electronic calculator manufacturer, approached Intel for the manufacture of 12 discrete ICs to be used in its products to perform different functions. Intel later (in 1971) designed and created a single chip containing 2,300 transistors...